

I Bind Unto Myself Today

Words: attributed to St. Patrick of Ireland (circa 387-466). Paraphrased by Cecil F. Alexander, 1889.
Music: 'St. Patricks Breastplate' Charles V. Stanford, 1902. Setting: "The English Hymnal", 1906.
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♩ = 120

1. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The strong Name of the
2. I bind this day to me for - - ev - er By pow - er of faith, Christ's
3. I bind un - to my - self the pow - er Of the great love
4. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The vir - - tues of the
5. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The pow - er of God to

Tri - - ni - - ty, By in - - vo - - ca - - tion
in - - car - - na - - tion; His bap - - tism in the
cher - - u - - bim; The sweet "Well done" in
star lit heav - - en, The glor - - ious sun's life
hold and lead, His eye to watch, His

The first system of musical notation consists of three staves. The top staff is a single treble clef. The bottom two staves are grouped by a brace and represent a piano accompaniment, with a treble clef on top and a bass clef on the bottom. The music is in 4/4 time. The piano part features a steady eighth-note accompaniment in the right hand and a more complex bass line in the left hand, including some triplets. The voice part (top staff) has a melody that follows the general contour of the piano accompaniment.

The second system of musical notation is a first ending, indicated by a bracket and the number '1' at the beginning. It consists of three staves. The piano accompaniment (bottom two staves) continues with the same eighth-note pattern. The voice part (top staff) has a single note, likely a whole note, which concludes the first ending. The system ends with a double bar line and repeat dots.

The third system of musical notation is a second ending, indicated by a bracket and the number '2-9' at the beginning. It consists of three staves. The piano accompaniment (bottom two staves) continues with the same eighth-note pattern. The voice part (top staff) has a long note, likely a whole note, which concludes the second ending. The system ends with a double bar line and repeat dots.

same
riv - - - - er,
ho - - - - ur,
ray,
stay,

The first system of music consists of a vocal line on a single staff and a piano accompaniment on a grand staff (treble and bass staves). The vocal line begins with a whole note G4. The piano accompaniment features a sustained chord of G4 and B4 in the right hand, and a single note G3 in the left hand.

The second system of music continues the vocal and piano parts. The vocal line has a half note G4, followed by a quarter note A4, and then a half note B4 with a sharp sign. The piano accompaniment features a sustained chord of G4 and B4 in the right hand, and a single note G3 in the left hand.

The third system of music continues the vocal and piano parts. The vocal line has a half note G4, followed by a quarter note A4, and then a half note B4 with a sharp sign. The piano accompaniment features a sustained chord of G4 and B4 in the right hand, and a single note G3 in the left hand.

2. His burst - - - ing from the
3. Con - - - fes - - - sors' faith, A - - -
4. The flash - - - ing of of the
5. The wis - - - dom of my

The fourth system of music continues the vocal and piano parts. The vocal line has a half note G4, followed by a quarter note A4, and then a half note B4 with a sharp sign. The piano accompaniment features a sustained chord of G4 and B4 in the right hand, and a single note G3 in the left hand.

The fifth system of music continues the vocal and piano parts. The vocal line has a half note G4, followed by a quarter note A4, and then a half note B4 with a sharp sign. The piano accompaniment features a sustained chord of G4 and B4 in the right hand, and a single note G3 in the left hand.

up - pray - ers, the tem - pest - uous shield to ward; His com - ing deeds
 wind's guide, His shield to ward; All good sta - ble of
 The word of

6. Against the demon snares of sin,
 The vice that gives temptation force,
 The natural lusts that war within,
 The hostile men that mar my course;
 Or few or many, far or nigh,
 In every place and in all hours,
 Against their fierce hostility
 I bind to me these holy powers.

8. Christ be with me, Christ within me,
 Christ behind me, Christ before me,
 Christ beside me, Christ to win me,
 Christ to comfort and restore me.
 Christ beneath me, Christ above me,
 Christ in quiet, Christ in danger,
 Christ in hearts of all that love me,
 Christ in mouth of friend and stranger.

7. Against all Satan's spells and wiles,
Against false words of heresy,
Against the knowledge that defiles,
Against the heart's idolatry,
Against the wizard's evil craft,
Against the death wound and the burning,
The choking wave, the poisoned shaft,
Protect me, Christ, till Thy returning.

9. I bind unto myself the Name,
The strong Name of the Trinity,
By invocation of the same,
The Three in One and One in Three.
By Whom all nature hath creation,
Eternal Father, Spirit, Word:
Praise to the Lord of my salvation,
Salvation is of Christ the Lord.